

THE IMPACT OF ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE ON EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION(IN ACASE OF GOVERNMENTAL ORGANIZATION IN ASELLA CITY ETHIOPIA).

A RESEARCH PAPER SUBMITTED TO THE DEPARTMENT OF MANAGEMENT IN PARTIAL FULFILLMENT OF THE REQUIREMENT FOR THE BACHELOR OF DEGREE



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ARSI UNIVERSITY

COLLEGE OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

DEPARTMENT OF MANAGEMENT

PREPARED BY:1. FIKRU BOKANSA.....ID.NO 9668/13

2.FOZIYA JEMAL.....ID.NO 9671/13

ADVISOR:MR TOKUMA BOKU

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ASELLA, ETHIOPIA

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CHAPTER ONE

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Backgrounder of the study

Communication is the art of that determines the survival and growth of individual organization institution and countries at large. Communication is the process of sharing thought ideas and feeling with each other in commonly understandable way. The art of the communication which compasses all living beings and pervades animal worlds as well as old as mankind thousands of years ago people use communicate orally it has involved over the years with a reference to back in time to the biblical era when people learn to express themselves even before they evolved fully in their present form sounds grunts action signs gesture gesticulation to the spoken and word. Then after that the world reading writing and modern sophisticated method of communication was started now a days the survival performance and success predominantly depends on the type of communication it uses a more effective communication beside other rescores and factors determines the service provision or production despite the rare vireos factors that determined effective communication organizational structure ore se affections the effectiveness in an organization (madhukar 2010)

An organization is group of people working together to achieve common goal and communication is vital part in that process organizational success in dynamic global market place so communication is life blood of organization. No organization can develop in the absence of effective communication system. Whatever site of the organization is big or small communication is essential to fulfill the organization need and want according to Bovee and till (200) effective communication occurs when individual achieve a shared understanding situation other to take action and encourage thinking in a new way. Keith Davis (2013), say communication is the process of passing the information and understanding from one person to another. It essential a bridge of meaning between the people by using the bridge a person can safely across their reveres of misunderstanding.

According to William Scott (2014), in this book organization theory communication is process which involves the transmission and accomplish organizational goal. communication is the vital part of every organization as it is for individual we use oral and written communication to share

knowledge and message with other at work place and home communication is too important for organization because it is the foundation of our personal group and structural as well as professionals relationship effective communication skill are tools for archiving our goals and getting the result we want because both employees and the organization benefit from effective communication any problem in the communication part leads to fatal problems to the organization and in certain circumstance even beyond ineffective communication leads to repeated absents lack of focus on organizations objective employee turnover careless and decrease organizational competitiveness such ineffective communication has something to do with organizational structure logically organizational structure is the frame work that facilitate communication and efficient work processes an ineffective communication emerging from organizational structure has multidimensional repercussions

Lack of effective communication result in multifaceted problem low productivity, unequal workload, unclear chain of command, lack of team spirit slow decision making and poor innovation are signal of poor communication to mention, such poor communication may source from organization structure

Therefore, the above-mentioned points the researcher to undertake this study in this study the researcher will assess the impact of organization structure on effective communication flow in daily activity of organization.

1.2 Statement of the problem

Lack of effective communication and inability to identify reasons for infective communication tempts survival and growth of business organizational similarly ineffective communication in government or other nonprofit organizations hampers efficiency and effectiveness in the service provision and objective realization “information is might “is the adage and the mantra that prevalent indifferent literature since the beginning of 21st century. Information determines the survival and growth of business organizations and it is also the main platform to offer public service efficiently and effectively in the absence of information, data cannot be translated into knowledge and finally into episode which fundamentally deter mains the competitiveness and transformation of organization however the main issues in the success of transformation from data to knowledge and finally to wisdom dependence on the type of communication among

parties communication among parties indicates the exchange of ideas that service the mission and the vision of the organization it is the bond between or among employers groups work units dependents and top exclusive either formally or informally success of organizations predominantly detrained by the effectiveness of internal as well as external communication (Krizan, marries, and Johns (2014)).

Many studies have been conducted on factors that affect the effectiveness communication under different setting. Communication in general and effective communication in particular are affected by different internal and external factors an organization. Factors such as the means of communication. The type of communication, parties involved in the communication the place of the organization and other affect the exchange of ideas and its productivity. Nonetheless, no study has evaluated the impact of organization structure on effective communication. Among other factors determines the effectiveness of communication in the organization.

Cognizant to the factors mentioned above, lack of effective communication is the main reason for the lack of good governance. Low productivity, unequal workload, unclear chain of command. Lack of team spirit, slow decision making, and poor innovation in the governmental organization. One of the factored that may affect effective communication is structure of the organization. However, no study has evaluated the impact of organizational structure on effective communication. This study, therefore investigate the impact of organizational stretcher on effective communication with special emphases on internal communication with a case study from governmental organization in Asella city, Ethiopia.

1.3 Object of the study

1.3.1 General objective

The general objectivity of this study is to investigate the impact of organizational structure on effective communication

1.3.2 Specific objective

The following point would be the specific of objective of the study

1. To recognize the type of communication and the style of communication used in governmental organization

2. To detect the constraints or challenges for the effective communication used in governmental organization
3. To examine organizational structure used in governmental organization
4. To identify the factors that affect effective communication within an organization.
5. To examine the impact of organization structure on effective communication in governmental organizations

1.4 Basic research questions

The following would be basic research questions of this study are: -

1. What type of communication style is being used in governmental organization?
2. To what extent communications being used in governmental organizations are effective?
3. What look like organizational structure used in governmental organization?
4. What are the factors that affect effective communication in governmental organizations?
5. What is impact of organizational structure on effective communication in governmental organization?

1.5 Significance of the study

This study will have multidimensional benefit to both academic and practitioners. The study will provide necessary information with will help Asella city administrator to understand their weaknesses and strengths on communication and organizational structure part. The study will also open an insight on the impact of organizational structure on communication as whole and effective communication.

1.6 Scope of the study

The study will focus only on the impact of organizational structure on effective communication flow in some selected government organizations in Asella city, Ethiopia. It will try to analyse the case of communication problem in the organization manner of communication type of communication problems and consequence of ineffective communication on performance of employee in organization

CHAPTER TWO

2. REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE

2.1 Definition of communication

In different time different writers define the word “communication” in different ways. The word communication is singular from is different from plural, communications. When we attempt to define communication, over the years, has seen numerous dimensions. Redfield says communication is the process of exchange of facts, ideas, and opinions a means that individuals or organization use for sharing and understanding with one another. In other word, it is the transmission and interaction of fact, idea, opinion or emotion and feeling or attitude. Communication is exchange of information, through and emotion between individual and groups, in other word, communication plays a fundamental role in balancing individual and organizational objective (Boyaci, 2008 p3-5). Communication is process of conveying information from a sender to a receiver with the use of media in which the communicated information is understood the same way by both sender and receiver (Shumban Sharma 2016).

Communication is also an interdisciplinary subject. It encompasses literature, psychology, sociology, ecology, linguistic, system analysis, auditing, accounting, and statistics. Communication enables us to do important this: to grow, to learn, to be aware of ourselves and to adjust to our environment. The word communication is complex, expansive and an evolving word. It assumes a very dynamic character as the methods. Channels instruments and approaches relating to the process of communication respond to new situation and challenge. The spectrum of communication assumes a pervasive quality in the contemporary world and defies description

as it constantly reaches out and assumes new meaning. Communication is to be understood in terms of what it does. More than discipline, it is the way of life. Business communication R.K Medhukare, 2016: p 18-20).

Communication is an exchange of facts, idea, opinion or emotion, by two or more people. Communication is intercourse by words, letters, symbols, or messages and as way that one organization members share meaning understanding with another (New man and summer 2000). Communication is sending and receiving of messages by mean of symbols and in that context organizational communication is key element of organizational climate (Drenth et.al. 2008). Communication is transfer of information from sender to receiver under the condition that the receiver understands the message (Weihrich and Koontz, 2010).

2.2 Role of communication in organization

Communication plays a very important role in an organization. In fact, it is said to be the life wire of the organization. Nothing in the universe, human or otherwise that does not communicates, through the means of communication may be different. Communication is very crucial and unavoidable since we have intentions which we want to pass across to another person, group or even to the outside world. Communication in an organization is a vital. Departments communicate from time to time in respect to daily activities and the organizations relationship with the external world. However, what is being communication may be will understood and the feedback or misunderstood or insufficient and thus communication breakdown. In fact, communication within organization could be grapevine or rum ours. In all, communication in organization is very complex and it needs to be correctly handled and monitored to avoid chaos, crisis or conflict.

The basic function and role of the management could not to be performed without communication. Planning, organizing, coordinating, budgeting, monitoring, controlling, staffing, delegation, and including marking, production, financing, human resource management, research and development, purchasing, selling, could not be well coordinated and goal achieved without communication ([http: Elia Articles.com](http://EliaArticles.com)).

2.3 Importance of communication

Communication is important for the following reasons:-

- A. Aid to managerial performance: managers transmit the objectives of the organization to subordinates through the communication major problems may solve without difficulty, and thus communication acts as a tool of management.
- B. Achieving coordination: in large organization employees works the base of specialization and division of works. So, there is a need of coordination. This coordination achieved through communication.
- C. Help in decision making: good communication system provides all necessary information, which enables managers to take quality decisions in the proper time.
- D. Smooth organization operation: communication helps workers to the real situation. In an organization and workers perform their activities without any delay, which leads to the functioning of an organization. (ArvindKummer, 2012).

2.4 The communication process

2.4.1 Elements of communication process

The various element of communication process are:

- A. Sender: The people who transmits, speak, or communicates a message or operates an electronic devices is the one who conceives and initiates the message with the purpose of informing, persuading, influencing, and changing the attitude, opinion or behavior of the receiver (audience listener). H he/she decides the communication symbols, the channel, and the time for sending the situation in which communication take place.
- B. Message: Idea or thought or the raw from of telling the ideas that the symbols.
- C. Encoding: Is changing the raw idea from its mental from in to symbols, that is, patterns of words, gestures, pictorial from or sings/physical or sound/ of a specific visual or language.
- D. Medium (channel): Is the carrier of the message such as written words, in the form of written communication, and spoken words and gestures in the form of face-to-face discussion.

- E. Receiver: is changing the raw idea from its mental form into symbols, that is, patterns of words, gestures, pictorial forms or signs /physical or sound/ of a specific visual or language.
- F. Decoding: this is the act of translating symbols of communication into their ordinary meaning; however, the total meanings of the words/symbols/ together with tone and attitude of sender as treated by the structure of the message and the choice of words used by him/the sender/.
- G. Feedback: Is your receiver's response, the final link in the communication chain. Feedback is the key element in the communication process because it enables you to evaluate the effectiveness of your message. If your audience doesn't understand what you mean, your call tells the response and refines your message (Communication Hand Book Sandra Cleary 2003 P3-70).

2.5 Barriers of communication

Communication barrier is any factor which prevents the smooth flow of the message from the sender to the receiver. Because of the complexity of the communication process, any possible barrier or breakdown can arise. No two persons are exactly alike mentally, or emotionally. Thus the innumerable human differences plus cultural, social and environmental differences may cause problems in conveying intended message. Although all types of communication are subject to misunderstandings. The major barriers of communication include the following:

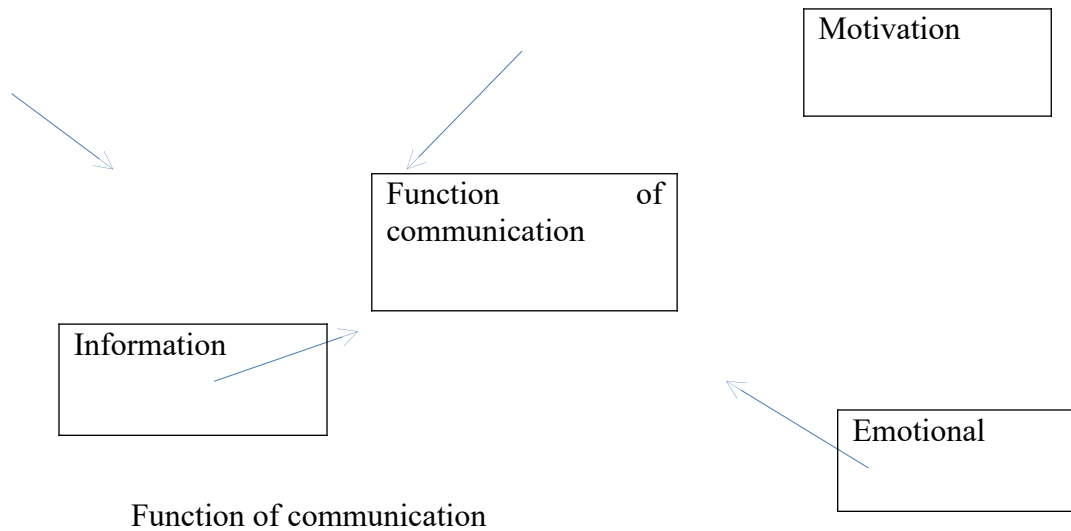
- A. Channel selection: communication may be oral, written, visual or audio-visual. The different communication channels can be personal barriers in that some individuals always seem to incline toward a particular channel even though a more effective one exists. While a properly chosen medium can add to the effectiveness of a communication, an unusual medium may act as a barrier to it.
- B. Physical barrier: It includes noise, time, and distance.
 - 1. Noise: Anything that interferes with communication and distorts or blocks the message is noise. In factories oral communication could be difficult by the noise of machines.
 - 2. Time: to make communication effective, it should be done at the right time and right place. Trying to communicate at an inappropriate time for the sender and receiver will not bring the desired outcome.

3. Distance: Where people sits or stand can be an important factor in their receiving and transmitting message of course distance between sender and receiver also affect their communication.
- C. Semantics: refer to the different uses and meaning of words and symbols. Words and symbols may not have similar uses and meaning for different individuals from different cultural group, language and living style so it may create some barrier in communication process. A semantic barrier includes: Interpretation of words, By passed instruction, Denotation, connotation and euphoniums.
- D. Perception of reality: the reality of objective, an event or a person is to different people. Reality is not a fixed concept; it is complex, infinite and continually changing. Besides, each human being has limited sensory perception-touch. People perceive reality in different way. No two people perceive reality in identical manners.
- E. Attitude and opinion: communication effectiveness is influenced also by the attitude and opinion of the communication have in their mental filters people tend to react favorably when the message they receive agrees with their view towards the information, the set of facet, and the sender. In addition, the sometimes unrelated circumstances affect their attitude, and response like: Emotional state, Favorable or unfavorable information, Closed mind, Status consciousness and Receiver capability.
- F. Information over load: if the sender improper, inaccurate or too much information will suffer information over load happen when individual receive more information than they are capable of processing. The implication is that individuals can effectively process only certain amount of information (Business communication Bovee and Thill, p17-20).

2.6 Function of communication

Communication services four major functions within a group

Controlling



- A. Control: communication acts as to control member behavior in several ways. Organizational level authority hierarchies and formal guidelines the employees are required to follow. When employees, for instances are required to first communicate any job related grievance to their immediate boss, to follow their job description, or the company poleis, communication is performing a control function.
 - B. Motivation: communication fosters motivation by clarify to employees what is to be done, how well they are doing, and can what be done to improve performance if it's subpar. We saw this operating in our review of goal setting and reinforcement theories. The formal of specific goals, feedback on progress towards the goal and reinforcement of desired behavior all stimulate motivation and require communication.
 - C. Emotional expression: that takes place within the group is a fundamental and feelings of satisfaction. Communication therefor, provides a release for the motivation expression of feelings and fulfillment of social need.
 - D. Information: is the final function that communication performing release to its role in facilitating decision making. It provides the information that individuals and groups need to make decision by transmitting the data to identify and evaluated alternative choices.
- <http://www.media fire.com/>

2.7 Methods of communication

Communication takes place by two methods. These two methods of communication are:

2.7.1 Verbal communication

It is ability to communicate by using words that separates human beings from rest of animal's kingdom. Verbal communication includes both oral and written communication, (Raymond L. Hilger, 2010, p250).

A. Written communication

It is written on paper or boards, charts. Written communication is used for many purpose, it includes, letters, memos notice, reports and others.

1. Letter: - is the most commonly used form of written communication. They are mostly used for external communication. Letter has a fixed and formal layout. This must be adhered to. It can be sales letter, compliant letters, bank correspondence and many others.
2. Memo: - this is an informal communication between members of the same organization and usually relates to day- to-day work. It is used to convey information and instructions. Memo contains brief messages. A memo may or may not be signed. It can be personalized for senior managers.
3. Notice: - this is used when many people in an organization have to be given the same information. A notice should be short and to the point. It should be clear and well-spaced for easy reading.
4. Report: - this is written document prepared by individuals or committee. It is prepared after research.

B. Oral communication

Oral communication refers "spoken words". Any communication which we can hear, lectures in the class room, speeches of politicians at rallies, instructions, and event songs, poetry recitation, and other. Oral communication occurs in situation like conversation, telephone talk, interviews, presentation, and meeting.

1. Face-to face communication: oral communication is best when it is face-to- face. It is possible between two individuals in a meeting or interview. Communication follows

in both directions. There is immediate feedback. Facial expression, body movement and body language communication are giving more meaning. In face to face communication style ineffective when listener is not interested.

2. Telephone: speaking on the telephone depends entirely on the voice and the words used. It does not require physical presence.
3. Interview: it is a meeting between an interviewer who can be one or many and an interviewee or candidate. The interviewer asks relevant questions to the candidate.
4. Meeting: usually, meeting involves a number of persons. The chairman guides the proceeding and maintains order during the meeting. During on the type of meeting, there may or may not be a fixed agenda. If it is formal meeting, notes are taken during the meeting, which are called the “minutes”.
5. Presentation: this is formal well prepared talk given by an individual to group. The audience is mostly knowledgeable and or interested. The responsibility of the presenter is to make sure that all the listener understand the matter which he or she is presenting and opens up questions after presentation.(Business communication Bovee and Thill 2008).

2.7.2 Non- verbal communication

Nonverbal communication is the process of communicating through sending and receiving wordless message. The receiver of communication should be in position of to see hear and feel the communicator. The receiver of the communication should be in the position to clearly see the face, the gesture, the tone, the dress, the appearance and also hear the voice of the communicator. Nonverbal communication takes place through the following ways,(Business communication Bovee and Thill 2008).

1. Facial expression: - it is said that face is index of mind. The thought and the feeling of the heart often find expression on the face. One makes on the face. One makes on an attempt to read the facial expression when one uses the following expressions:-To carry a mask on one's face, To carry a wooden expression, To make face, The smile of acknowledgement or recognition

2. Eye:- the eyes are indeed the most expressive part of human face. The eyes of a person are often said to face a tale. In fact, the eye are the most commonly described part of the body .The feelings of heart quite often find expression through the eyes. In the expression of love, affection, sincerity and other the eye contact become crucial.
3. Posture and gestures:-posture refers to the carriage, state and attitude of body or mind. Gesture refers to any significant movement of limb or body and deliberate use of such movement as an expression of feeling.
4. Personal space:-personal space or the space between during their interactions with each other segment of non-verbal communication.
5. Behavior:- the way in which one conducts one self and behaves in the process of communication is another very forceful facet of non –verbal communication.
6. Appearance:-physical presence and appearance of a person play a key role in the process of communication.
7. Smile:-is a very potent from of facial expression .It open the door to communication. A nature, pleasant smile carries great significant in establishing society, community or business organization. (Business communication Bovee and thill).

2.7.3 Channel of communication network

In every organization there are two types of communication network channels. These are: formal or official channels and informal channels of communication. Both channels carry message from one person or group to another in an organization down ward, horizontal/lateral/and diagonal /cross channel/ communication.

2 .7.4 Formal communication channel

The formal communication channel is that flows along the organization's line of authority. They represent the flow of communication within flow of communication with in formal organizational structure. Typically, communication flows in four separate direction:/Business communication Bovee and Thill 2008.

A. Downward communication.

The communication that involves a message exchange between two or more level of the organizational hierarchy is called downward /vertical/communication. Formal message flows from managers and supervisors to subordinates are called down ward communication. Most of down ward communication involves:- Giving instruction, Job relational-explanation of how one task related to other task, Organization policy and procedures, Organization goals and mission and Management directives and job plan.

B. Upward communication

Formal message also flow upward from subordinates to supervisors and managers. Without upward communication, management would never know how their downward message were received and interpreted by employees. Upward communication provides the feedback necessary to let supervisors know whether subordinates received and understood messages that were not sent upward communication these types of message are valuable: What subordinates are doing, feedback Report of customers interaction feedback Suggestion of ideas for improvements within department organization as whole association and their organization outline of unsolved work problems on which subordinates now need aid or How subordinates think and feel about each other and their job, there may require help in the future.

C. Horizontal/lateral/ communication

Horizontal communication involves exchange of information among individuals on the same organizational level, such as a cross or within department. Horizontal communication is important to help coordinate work assignment, share information on plans and activities, problem solving, conflicts resolution and develop interpersonal support, thereby creating a more cohesive work unit.

D. Diagonal/cross-channel/ communication

Diagonal communication is the exchange of information among employees in different work units who are neither subordinates nor superior to each other. Communication that takes between a manager and employees of other work groups is called diagonal communication.

2.7.5 Informal communication channel

Informal communication channel, commonly referred to as the grapevine, are a normal outgrowth of information and casual groupings of people on the job, of their social interactions and of their understandable desired to communication with one another. Every organization has

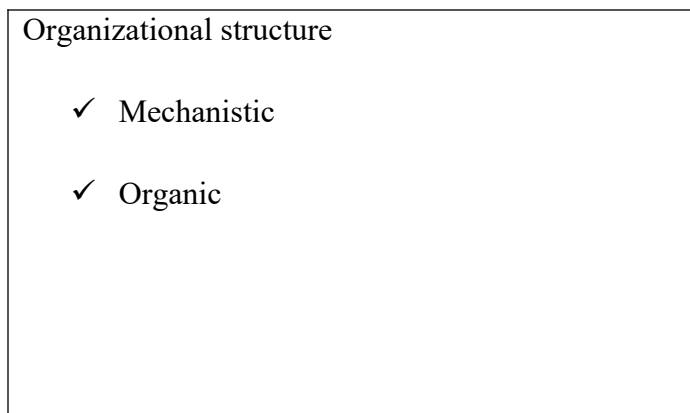
an informal communication network has its grape vine that supplements official channel. The grapevine offers members among organization an out let for their imagination and an opportunity to express their apprehension in the form of rumor.(Ray Mond L. Hilgert 2010 p56-62).

2.7.6 Conceptual framework

Organization structure affects the effectiveness of communication in the organization. organizational structure takes two forms mechanistic and organic ,mechanistic structure is featured with stable environments ,tasks are broken down in to specialized and separate tasks ,strict hierarchy of authority, vertical communication and all decision are made at the top .on the other hand organic organization structure is characterized by tasks adjusted and refined by employee interaction ,less hierarchy of authority decentralized decision making ,and lateral communication. Both structures have their own impact on the effectiveness of communication.

Effectiveness of communication can be represented by clarity, legality, Validity, and reliability of the communication organizational structure determine the clarity understandability, reliability and validity of communication which in aggregate determines the effectiveness of communication as shown on figure one below

Figure 2 Conceptual framework



Effective communication

- | |
|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">✓ Clear✓ Legal✓ Reliable✓ Valid✓ Understandable |
|---|

CHAPTER THREE

3. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

To collect and analyze the data the researcher has used the following methodology.

3.1 Research design

Methodologically, descriptive type of research design will be applied followed by both quantitative and qualitative approach. The quantitative approach will focus on obtaining numerical findings of close ended questions; while the qualitative approach is concerned with explaining open ended questions.

3.2 Data type and source

The source of the data includes both primary and secondary data. The primary data will be collected from questionnaires and interviews in the employee and manager of governmental

organization in Asella city, Ethiopia. Secondary sources data will be collected from records, written documents and manual written about the organization.

3.3 Data collection techniques

To collect the relevant data from the study different data collection tools will be used. Self – administered questionnaire was prepared and distributed to respondents (employees). To support the data obtained through questionnaires disseminated to the employees, and interview will be conducted with the manager of the organization. The secondary data will be gathered by reviewing recorded documents, books and manual from the organization and the Internet.

3.4 Sampling technique and sample size

The sampling technique that the researcher use in this study will be stratified random sampling. First populations will be divided in to sub groups/ strata. such as, Asella municipality, Asella city education department, and Asella city public relationship and human resource development service.

The total numbers of employees in the organizations under the study will be 152. Among these Asella city education department 25, Asella city public relationship and human resource development service 35 will be selected by proportional stratified sampling technique.

The reasons for selecting of stratified random sampling will be:

Every items or person in the population has chance of being selected for the sample

The existence of different groups of organizations like: Asella city education department, and Asella city public relationship and human resource development service.

According to Israel (Glenn (2010), the role of sample size determination, sample size of the above data determined were mathematically as follows:

Name of the organization	No of employees	Sample size
Asella city Education department	64	25
Asella public relationship & human resource development.	88	35
Total	152	60

$$\text{Mathematically } n = \frac{N}{1 + N(e)^2} \quad n = \frac{152}{1 + 152(0.1)^2} = 60$$

$$n_1 = n \left(\frac{N_1}{N} \right) = 60 \left(\frac{64}{152} \right) = 25$$

n=Sample size

e=Sample error

Where, N=total no of population

$$n_2 = n \left(\frac{N_2}{N} \right) = 60 \left(\frac{88}{152} \right) = 35$$

N_1 = total population of first population subgroup

N_2 = total population of the second population subgroup

n_1 = sample size of the first population subgroup

n_2 = sample size of the second population subgroup

Therefore, the total sample element will be 60.

3.5 Data analysis technique

After collection of data needed, the data will be organized and analyzed using simple descriptive analysis statics like percentage and table that the relevance organization structure on effective communication. Finally, the result of the analysis will be expressed through tabulation and qualitatively.

4. Time schedule

No	Activities	December	January	February
1	Title Selection			
2	Literature Review			
3	Collect Data			
4	Classification of Data			
5	Write Proposal			
6	Submit Proposal			
7	Presentation of Research			

5. Budget breakdown

No	Description	Quantity	Unit Cost (Birr)	Total Cost (Birr)
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1	Paper package	30	2	60
2	Typing and Print	30	3	90
3	Binding	2	30	60
4	Transportation	3days	150	450
5	Internet	5days	150	750
6	Copy	20	3	60
Total				1530

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